

P8131 Homework 3

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Problem 1: Esophageal Cancer and Alcohol Consumption

The following table gives data from a retrospective study between esophageal cancer and daily alcohol consumption adjusted for age.

Age	Case 0-79g	Case 80+g	Control 0-79g	Control 80+g
25-34	0	1	106	9
35-44	5	4	164	26
45-54	21	25	138	29
55-64	34	42	139	27
65-74	36	19	88	18
75+	8	5	31	0

```
# Input data
# Create data frame with all cells
age_midpoint <- c(25, 35, 45, 55, 65, 75)

# Case data
case_low <- c(0, 5, 21, 34, 36, 8) # 0-79g alcohol
case_high <- c(1, 4, 25, 42, 19, 5) # 80+g alcohol

# Control data
ctrl_low <- c(106, 164, 138, 139, 88, 31) # 0-79g alcohol
ctrl_high <- c(9, 26, 29, 27, 18, 0) # 80+g alcohol

# Create long-format data for prospective analysis
# Each row: age, alcohol (0=low, 1=high), case count, control count
data1 <- data.frame(
  age = rep(age_midpoint, each = 2),
  alcohol = rep(c(0, 1), 6),
  case = c(rbind(case_low, case_high)),
  control = c(rbind(ctrl_low, ctrl_high))
)

data1$total <- data1$case + data1$control
```

(a) Fit a prospective model to the data to study the relation between alcohol consumption, age, and disease (model age as a continuous variable taking values 25, 35, 45, 55, 65, and 75). Interpret the result.

For a retrospective (case-control) study, although we sample based on disease status, we can still fit a prospective logistic model to estimate the odds ratio, since the odds ratio is symmetric (same whether estimated prospectively or retrospectively).

The model:

$$\log\left(\frac{\pi}{1-\pi}\right) = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \cdot \text{Age} + \beta_2 \cdot \text{Alcohol}$$

where $\pi = P(\text{Disease} = 1 | \text{Age}, \text{Alcohol})$ and Alcohol = 1 for 80+ g/day, 0 otherwise.

```
# Fit prospective logistic regression model
fit_prospective <- glm(cbind(case, control) ~ age + alcohol,
                      family = binomial(link = "logit"), data = data1)
summary(fit_prospective)

##
## Call:
## glm(formula = cbind(case, control) ~ age + alcohol, family = binomial(link = "logit"),
##      data = data1)
##
## Coefficients:
##              Estimate Std. Error z value Pr(>|z|)
## (Intercept) -5.023449   0.418224 -12.011  <2e-16 ***
## age          0.061579   0.007291   8.446  <2e-16 ***
## alcohol      1.780000   0.187086   9.514  <2e-16 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## (Dispersion parameter for binomial family taken to be 1)
##
##      Null deviance: 211.608  on 11  degrees of freedom
## Residual deviance:  31.932  on   9  degrees of freedom
## AIC: 78.259
##
## Number of Fisher Scoring iterations: 4

# Extract coefficients and confidence intervals
coefs <- summary(fit_prospective)$coefficients
ci <- confint.default(fit_prospective)

# Odds ratios
OR_age <- exp(coef(fit_prospective)["age"])
OR_alcohol <- exp(coef(fit_prospective)["alcohol"])

# OR confidence intervals
OR_ci_age <- exp(ci["age", ])
OR_ci_alcohol <- exp(ci["alcohol", ])

cat("Odds Ratio for Age (per 10-year increase):", round(OR_age^10, 4), "\n")

## Odds Ratio for Age (per 10-year increase): 1.8511

cat("95% CI:", round(OR_ci_age^10, 4), "\n\n")
```

```
## 95% CI: 1.6046 2.1355
```

```
cat("Odds Ratio for Alcohol (80+g vs 0-79g):", round(OR_alcohol, 4), "\n")
```

```
## Odds Ratio for Alcohol (80+g vs 0-79g): 5.9299
```

```
cat("95% CI:", round(OR_ci_alcohol, 4), "\n")
```

```
## 95% CI: 4.1096 8.5564
```

Interpretation:

1. **Age effect:** $\hat{\beta}_1 = 0.06158$ ($p < 0.001$). For each 10-year increase in age, the odds of esophageal cancer increase by a factor of $e^{10 \times 0.06158} = 1.851$ (95% CI: 1.605 – 2.135), holding alcohol consumption constant.
2. **Alcohol effect:** $\hat{\beta}_2 = 1.78$ ($p < 0.001$). The odds of esophageal cancer for high alcohol consumption (80+ g/day) are $e^{1.78} = 5.93$ times the odds for low alcohol consumption (0-79 g/day), adjusting for age (95% CI: 4.11 – 8.556).
3. **Model fit:** The residual deviance is 31.93 on 9 degrees of freedom. Comparing to $\chi^2_{0.95}(9) = 16.92$, the deviance exceeds the threshold, suggesting some lack of fit ($p = 2 \times 10^{-4}$). This could be due to the assumption that age has a linear effect on the log-odds, or potential interaction between age and alcohol.

Conclusion: Both age and high alcohol consumption are significantly associated with increased risk of esophageal cancer.

(b) Let Ψ_j be the odds ratio relating alcohol consumption and disease in the j^{th} age group ($j = 1, \dots, 6$). Assume different age groups have different odds. Compare the following two models:

- $M_0 : \Psi_j = 1$ for all j
- $M_1 : \Psi_j = \Psi$ (where Ψ is an unknown constant)

Model Formulation:

For each age group j , let $\pi_{j,k}$ be the probability of disease given alcohol level k ($0 = \text{low}$, $1 = \text{high}$). The odds ratio in age group j is:

$$\Psi_j = \frac{\pi_{j,1}/(1 - \pi_{j,1})}{\pi_{j,0}/(1 - \pi_{j,0})}$$

Model M_0 : $\Psi_j = 1$ for all j means alcohol has no effect on disease within any age group.

$$\text{logit}(\pi) = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \cdot \text{Age}$$

This model includes only age (as a continuous variable), with no alcohol effect.

Model M_1 : $\Psi_j = \Psi$ (constant) means the odds ratio for alcohol is the same across all age groups. For any age group j ,

$$\text{logit}(\pi_{j,1}) - \text{logit}(\pi_{j,0}) = \log(\Psi) = \beta_2$$

which means $\log(\Psi_j) = \beta_2$ is the same for all j . Therefore $\Psi_j = e^{\beta_2} = \Psi$ is constant across all age groups, consistent with the logistic regression model structure.

$$\text{logit}(\pi) = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \cdot \text{Age} + \beta_2 \cdot \text{Alcohol}$$

M_0 is nested within M_1 (set $\beta_2 = 0$ in M_1 to get M_0).

```
# Fit M0: Only age effect (no alcohol effect, implies Psi_j = 1)
fit_M0 <- glm(cbind(case, control) ~ age,
              family = binomial(link = "logit"), data = data1)

# Fit M1: Age effect + constant alcohol effect (Psi_j = Psi for all j)
fit_M1 <- glm(cbind(case, control) ~ age + alcohol,
              family = binomial(link = "logit"), data = data1)

# Deviance analysis
dev_M0 <- fit_M0$deviance
dev_M1 <- fit_M1$deviance
df_M0 <- fit_M0$df.residual
df_M1 <- fit_M1$df.residual

# Test statistic: difference in deviances
dev_diff <- dev_M0 - dev_M1
df_diff <- df_M0 - df_M1
p_value <- 1 - pchisq(dev_diff, df_diff)

cat("Model M0 (Psi_j = 1): Deviance =", round(dev_M0, 4), ", df =", df_M0, "\n")

## Model M0 (Psi_j = 1): Deviance = 124.3149 , df = 10

cat("Model M1 (Psi_j = Psi): Deviance =", round(dev_M1, 4), ", df =", df_M1, "\n")

## Model M1 (Psi_j = Psi): Deviance = 31.9315 , df = 9

cat("\nDeviance difference:", round(dev_diff, 4), "\n")

##
## Deviance difference: 92.3834

cat("df difference:", df_diff, "\n")

## df difference: 1

cat("Critical value chi^2_0.95(1):", round(qchisq(0.95, 1), 4), "\n")

## Critical value chi^2_0.95(1): 3.8415

cat("P-value:", format(p_value, scientific = TRUE, digits = 4), "\n")

## P-value: 0e+00
```

```
# Estimate of common odds ratio Psi
Psi_hat <- exp(coef(fit_M1)["alcohol"])
ci_Psi <- exp(confint.default(fit_M1)["alcohol", ])
cat("\nEstimate of common odds ratio Psi:", round(Psi_hat, 4), "\n")
```

```
##
## Estimate of common odds ratio Psi: 5.9299
```

```
cat("95% CI for Psi:", round(ci_Psi, 4), "\n")
```

```
## 95% CI for Psi: 4.1096 8.5564
```

Deviance Analysis:

Since M_0 is nested within M_1 , we can use the likelihood ratio test:

$$D_{M_0} - D_{M_1} \sim \chi^2(df_{M_0} - df_{M_1}) \text{ under } H_0 : \beta = 0$$

- Test statistic: 92.3834
- Degrees of freedom: 1
- Critical value $\chi^2_{0.95}(1)$: 3.8415
- P-value: 0e+00

Conclusion: Since the test statistic (92.38) far exceeds the critical value (3.84), we reject M_0 in favor of M_1 at the 0.05 significance level. There is strong evidence that alcohol consumption is associated with esophageal cancer risk ($\Psi \neq 1$).

The estimated common odds ratio is $\hat{\Psi} = 5.93$ (95% CI: 4.11 – 8.556), indicating that high alcohol consumption (80+ g/day) is associated with approximately 5.9 times the odds of esophageal cancer compared to low consumption, across all age groups.

Problem 2: Orobanche Seed Germination

The following table provides data from a study of the germination of two species of Orobanche seeds. The seeds were grown on 1/125 dilutions of two different root extract media (cucumber or bean) in a 2 x 2 factorial layout with replicates. The data (y_i/m_i) consist of the number of seeds, m_i , and the number germinating, y_i , for each batch. Interest focuses on the possible differences in germination rates for the two types of seed and root extract.

```
# Input germination data
# O. aegyptiaca 75
bean_75 <- data.frame(
  germ = c(10, 23, 23, 26, 17),
  total = c(39, 62, 81, 51, 39),
  seed = "O. aegyptiaca 75",
  extract = "Bean"
)

cucumber_75 <- data.frame(
  germ = c(5, 53, 55, 32, 46, 10),
  total = c(6, 74, 72, 51, 79, 13),
```

```

    seed = "O. aegyptiaca 75",
    extract = "Cucumber"
)

# O. aegyptiaca 73
bean_73 <- data.frame(
  germ = c(8, 10, 8, 23, 0),
  total = c(16, 30, 28, 45, 4),
  seed = "O. aegyptiaca 73",
  extract = "Bean"
)

cucumber_73 <- data.frame(
  germ = c(3, 22, 15, 32, 3),
  total = c(12, 41, 30, 51, 7),
  seed = "O. aegyptiaca 73",
  extract = "Cucumber"
)

# Combine all data
germ_data <- rbind(bean_75, cucumber_75, bean_73, cucumber_73)
germ_data$not_germ <- germ_data$total - germ_data$germ
germ_data$seed <- factor(germ_data$seed)
germ_data$extract <- factor(germ_data$extract)

# Display data summary
kable(germ_data[, c("seed", "extract", "germ", "total")],
      col.names = c("Seed Type", "Extract", "Germinated", "Total"),
      caption = "Orobancha Seed Germination Data")

```

Table 1: Orobancha Seed Germination Data

Seed Type	Extract	Germinated	Total
O. aegyptiaca 75	Bean	10	39
O. aegyptiaca 75	Bean	23	62
O. aegyptiaca 75	Bean	23	81
O. aegyptiaca 75	Bean	26	51
O. aegyptiaca 75	Bean	17	39
O. aegyptiaca 75	Cucumber	5	6
O. aegyptiaca 75	Cucumber	53	74
O. aegyptiaca 75	Cucumber	55	72
O. aegyptiaca 75	Cucumber	32	51
O. aegyptiaca 75	Cucumber	46	79
O. aegyptiaca 75	Cucumber	10	13
O. aegyptiaca 73	Bean	8	16
O. aegyptiaca 73	Bean	10	30
O. aegyptiaca 73	Bean	8	28
O. aegyptiaca 73	Bean	23	45
O. aegyptiaca 73	Bean	0	4
O. aegyptiaca 73	Cucumber	3	12
O. aegyptiaca 73	Cucumber	22	41
O. aegyptiaca 73	Cucumber	15	30

Seed Type	Extract	Germinated	Total
O. aegyptiaca 73	Cucumber	32	51
O. aegyptiaca 73	Cucumber	3	7

(a) Fit a logistic regression model to study the relation between germination rates and different types of seed and root extract. Interpret the result.

Model:

$$\text{logit}(\pi_i) = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \cdot \text{Seed} + \beta_2 \cdot \text{Extract}$$

where Seed = 1 for O. aegyptiaca 75, Extract = 1 for Cucumber.

```
# Fit logistic regression with main effects
fit_germ <- glm(cbind(germ, not_germ) ~ seed + extract,
               family = binomial(link = "logit"), data = germ_data)
summary(fit_germ)

##
## Call:
## glm(formula = cbind(germ, not_germ) ~ seed + extract, family = binomial(link = "logit"),
##      data = germ_data)
##
## Coefficients:
##              Estimate Std. Error z value Pr(>|z|)
## (Intercept)    -0.7005     0.1507  -4.648 3.36e-06 ***
## seed0. aegyptiaca 75  0.2705     0.1547   1.748  0.0804 .
## extractCucumber      1.0647     0.1442   7.383 1.55e-13 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## (Dispersion parameter for binomial family taken to be 1)
##
##    Null deviance: 98.719  on 20  degrees of freedom
## Residual deviance: 39.686  on 18  degrees of freedom
## AIC: 122.28
##
## Number of Fisher Scoring iterations: 4

# Odds ratios and confidence intervals
OR <- exp(coef(fit_germ))
ci <- exp(confint.default(fit_germ))

results <- data.frame(
  Coefficient = round(coef(fit_germ), 4),
  OR = round(OR, 4),
  CI_lower = round(ci[, 1], 4),
  CI_upper = round(ci[, 2], 4),
  p_value = round(summary(fit_germ)$coefficients[, 4], 4)
)
kable(results, caption = "Logistic Regression Results (Standard Binomial)")
```

Table 2: Logistic Regression Results (Standard Binomial)

	Coefficient	OR	CI_lower	CI_upper	p_value
(Intercept)	-0.7005	0.4963	0.3694	0.6669	0.0000
seedO. aegyptiaca 75	0.2705	1.3106	0.9678	1.7748	0.0804
extractCucumber	1.0647	2.9001	2.1860	3.8474	0.0000

Interpretation:

1. **Seed type effect:** The coefficient for seed type (O. aegyptiaca 75 vs 73) is $\hat{\beta}_1 = 0.2705$ with OR = 1.311. O. aegyptiaca 75 has 1.311 times the odds of germination compared to O. aegyptiaca 73 ($p = 0.0804$). Note that the 95% CI (0.968 – 1.775) includes 1, suggesting the effect may not be statistically significant.
2. **Extract effect:** The coefficient for extract type (Cucumber vs Bean) is $\hat{\beta}_2 = 1.0647$ with OR = 2.9. Seeds grown on cucumber extract have 2.9 times the odds of germination compared to bean extract ($p = 0$).
3. **Model deviance:** Residual deviance = 39.69 on 18 df. Compared to $\chi^2_{0.95}(18) = 28.87$, the deviance is much larger, suggesting lack of fit which could indicate overdispersion.

(b) Is there overdispersion? If so, what is the estimate of dispersion parameter? Update your model and reinterpret the result.

```
# Check for overdispersion
# Pearson chi-squared statistic
pearson_resid <- residuals(fit_germ, type = "pearson")
G <- sum(pearson_resid^2)
n <- nrow(germ_data)
p <- length(coef(fit_germ))

# Estimate dispersion parameter
phi_hat <- G / (n - p)

cat("Pearson chi-squared statistic G =", round(G, 4), "\n")
```

```
## Pearson chi-squared statistic G = 38.3106
```

```
cat("Degrees of freedom (n - p) =", n - p, "\n")
```

```
## Degrees of freedom (n - p) = 18
```

```
cat("Estimated dispersion parameter phi_hat = G/(n-p) =", round(phi_hat, 4), "\n")
```

```
## Estimated dispersion parameter phi_hat = G/(n-p) = 2.1284
```



```
cat("Alternative estimate using deviance: D/(n-p) =",
    round(fit_germ$deviance / (n - p), 4), "\n")
```

```
## Alternative estimate using deviance: D/(n-p) = 2.2048
```

Assessment of overdispersion:

Under the standard binomial model, $E[G] \approx n - p = 18$ when the model is correct. We observe $G = 38.31$, which is substantially larger than expected.

The estimated dispersion parameter is:

$$\hat{\phi} = \frac{G}{n - p} = \frac{38.31}{18} = 2.128$$

Since $\hat{\phi} = 2.128 > 1$, there is evidence of **overdispersion** in the data.

```
# Adjust for overdispersion by specifying dispersion parameter
summary_adj <- summary(fit_germ, dispersion = phi_hat)
summary_adj
```

```
##
## Call:
## glm(formula = cbind(germ, not_germ) ~ seed + extract, family = binomial(link = "logit"),
##      data = germ_data)
##
## Coefficients:
##              Estimate Std. Error z value Pr(>|z|)
## (Intercept)    -0.7005     0.2199  -3.186  0.00144 **
## seed0. aegyptiaca 75  0.2705     0.2257   1.198  0.23081
## extractCucumber    1.0647     0.2104   5.061 4.18e-07 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## (Dispersion parameter for binomial family taken to be 2.128368)
##
##      Null deviance: 98.719  on 20  degrees of freedom
## Residual deviance: 39.686  on 18  degrees of freedom
## AIC: 122.28
##
## Number of Fisher Scoring iterations: 4
```

```
# Updated results with overdispersion adjustment
# Note: coefficients are the same, only SEs and p-values change
se_adj <- summary_adj$coefficients[, 2]
ci_adj <- cbind(
  coef(fit_germ) - 1.96 * se_adj,
  coef(fit_germ) + 1.96 * se_adj
)

results_adj <- data.frame(
  Coefficient = round(coef(fit_germ), 4),
  SE = round(se_adj, 4),
```

```

OR = round(OR, 4),
CI_lower = round(exp(ci_adj[, 1]), 4),
CI_upper = round(exp(ci_adj[, 2]), 4),
p_value = round(summary_adj$coefficients[, 4], 4)
)
kable(results_adj,
      caption = "Results Adjusted for Overdispersion")

```

Table 3: Results Adjusted for Overdispersion

	Coefficient	SE	OR	CI_lower	CI_upper	p_value
(Intercept)	-0.7005	0.2199	0.4963	0.3226	0.7638	0.0014
seedO. aegyptiaca 75	0.2705	0.2257	1.3106	0.8420	2.0397	0.2308
extractCucumber	1.0647	0.2104	2.9001	1.9201	4.3803	0.0000

Comparison of standard errors:

```

# Compare standard errors
se_comparison <- data.frame(
  Parameter = names(coef(fit_germ)),
  SE_binomial = round(summary(fit_germ)$coefficients[, 2], 4),
  SE_adjusted = round(se_adj, 4),
  Ratio = round(se_adj / summary(fit_germ)$coefficients[, 2], 4)
)
kable(se_comparison, caption = "Standard Error Comparison")

```

Table 4: Standard Error Comparison

	Parameter	SE_binomial	SE_adjusted	Ratio
(Intercept)	(Intercept)	0.1507	0.2199	1.4589
seedO. aegyptiaca 75	seedO. aegyptiaca 75	0.1547	0.2257	1.4589
extractCucumber	extractCucumber	0.1442	0.2104	1.4589

Reinterpretation with overdispersion adjustment:

After accounting for overdispersion ($\hat{\phi} = 2.128$):

1. **Seed type effect:** O. aegyptiaca 75 still has higher germination odds than O. aegyptiaca 73 (OR = 1.311), but the effect is not statistically significant at $\alpha = 0.05$ ($p = 0.2308$).
2. **Extract effect:** Cucumber extract is associated with higher germination odds than bean extract (OR = 2.9), and this effect remains statistically significant at $\alpha = 0.05$ ($p = 0$).
3. **Standard errors:** The standard errors are inflated by a factor of $\sqrt{\hat{\phi}} = \sqrt{2.128} = 1.459$ compared to the standard binomial model.

Conclusion: After adjusting for overdispersion, extract type remains statistically significant while seed type does not. Cucumber extract is associated with higher germination rates than bean extract.

(c) What is a plausible cause of the overdispersion?

1. **Intra-batch correlation:** Seeds within the same batch share environmental conditions, leading to correlated outcomes ($\text{Var}(Y) = m\pi(1 - \pi)\{1 + (m - 1)\rho\} > m\pi(1 - \pi)$).
2. **Batch-to-batch heterogeneity:** Unmeasured factors (seed quality, storage conditions) may cause germination probability to vary across batches beyond what seed type and extract explain.